



# Pawfolio

## System Proposal

A LinkedIn-style platform where stray and shelter pets build a résumé, apply for a home, and get "Hired" by their future Furparent.

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## SECTION 1

# Concept

**Pawfolio** is a LinkedIn-style platform for stray and shelter animals. Every pet has its own account and a profile written like a résumé: photos, a bio, temperament, skills, compatibility, and health notes.

Adoption works the way job hunting does. Instead of waiting on a static listing, the pet **applies for a home**. It finds people whose home and lifestyle fit its own, sends them an adoption request, and meets them in person at a Meet & Greet. If the meeting goes well, the pet gets **"Hired."** The person becomes a **Furparent**, and the two profiles stay linked from then on.

**Pets run their own accounts.** This is the playful premise of Pawfolio. Each pet speaks for itself, in first person, the same way a person represents themselves on LinkedIn. One account = one pet. In practice a caretaker (a foster, finder, or shelter volunteer) types on the pet's behalf, and that caretaker is the person the admin verifies.

## The job-hunting analogy

| On LinkedIn                | On Pawfolio                                                                                           |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Job seeker                 | Pet account                                                                                           |
| Résumé / profile           | Pet profile: photos, bio, temperament, skills, compatibility, health                                  |
| Company page / job posting | Human account's <b>Home Profile</b> : household, lifestyle, and what kind of pet they are looking for |
| "Open to Work"             | Pet status <b>Looking for a Home</b>                                                                  |
| "Hiring" badge             | Human's <b>Open to Adopt</b> toggle                                                                   |
| Recommended jobs           | <b>Homes for You</b> (pet side) and <b>Pets for You</b> (human side)                                  |
| Recruiter outreach         | <b>Invite to Apply</b> : a human nudges a pet they like to send a request                             |
| Job application            | <b>Adoption request</b> , sent by the pet to a human                                                  |
| Interview                  | <b>Meet &amp; Greet</b>                                                                               |
| Job offer accepted         | <b>Adopt</b> : the pet gets the "Hired" badge and the human becomes a Furparent                       |
| Alumni                     | <b>Alumni profile</b> , permanently linked to the Furparent                                           |

## SECTION 2

# Account Types

| Account      | Who it is                       | What it does                                                                                                                                                                                | Labels                                                    |
|--------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Human</b> | A person who wants to adopt     | Builds a Home Profile and takes the lifestyle quiz, browses pets, receives and reviews adoption requests from pets, hosts Meet & Greet, and makes the final Adopt or Decline decision.      | Open to Adopt<br><b>Furparent</b> (after an adoption)     |
| <b>Pet</b>   | One animal, representing itself | Builds its résumé, finds matching homes, sends adoption requests, books Meet & Greet, and posts updates.                                                                                    | Looking for a Home<br>In Process<br><b>Hired</b> (alumni) |
| <b>Admin</b> | Platform staff                  | Verifies new accounts, moderates content, manages accounts, resolves adoption issues, and views analytics and activity logs. Admin accounts are created by the system, not through sign-up. | —                                                         |

Every new Human and Pet account starts as **Pending Verification**. A pending account cannot use the platform. Logging in only shows a “Your account is pending approval” screen until an admin approves or denies it. See Section 5.1.

## SECTION 3

# Core Features

### 1 Pet Profiles (“résumés”)

Photos, first-person bio, temperament tags, skills (trained behaviors), compatibility (good with kids, dogs, cats), energy level, time it can be left alone, health and vet notes, and a status badge. Once adopted, it becomes an alumni profile with a “Hired” badge.

### 2 Home Profiles and Lifestyle Quiz

The human’s side of the match: home type, outdoor space, household members, other pets, activity level, hours away from home, experience, and pet preferences. Pets see the Home Profile the way a job seeker reads a job posting.

### 3 Matching and Suggestions

One compatibility score used in both directions. Humans get **Pets for You**, pets get **Homes for You**. Each match shows a percentage and the top reasons behind it (Section 6).

### 4 Adoption Requests

A structured form the pet sends to a specific human: a short cover letter (“Why I’d fit your home”), the caretaker’s notes, and the pet’s résumé and health summary attached automatically. This replaces a generic “contact us” message.

### 5 Meet & Greet Scheduling

Once a request is approved, the pet books one of the human’s available time slots. After the meeting time passes, the human chooses **Adopt** or **Decline**.

- 
- 6 Adoption and Alumni**  
Adopting is automatic once the human chooses Adopt. The pet is marked Adopted, the human becomes a Furparent, and the two profiles are linked. Nobody sets "Adopted" by hand.
- 
- 7 Account Verification**  
Admins review every new account before it can be used, which keeps both pets and people safe.
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**Supporting features:** bookmarks, notifications, a community feed with adoption stories, reporting and moderation, analytics for each role, and activity logs.

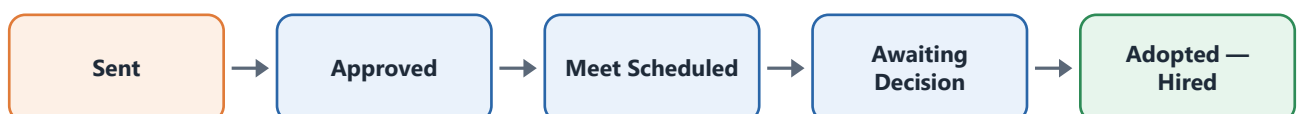
#### SECTION 4

## How It Works — Core Flow

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- |    |               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>Pet</b>    | Signs up and submits its verification details. The account shows <b>Pending Verification</b> and nothing else can be used yet.                                                                                                                                                               |
| 2  | <b>Human</b>  | Signs up the same way and waits for approval.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 3  | <b>Admin</b>  | Reviews each new account. <b>Approve:</b> the account can now be used. <b>Deny:</b> the owner sees the reason and can correct the details and resubmit.                                                                                                                                      |
| 4  | <b>Pet</b>    | Completes its résumé. Its status becomes <b>Looking for a Home</b> and it appears in search and matches.                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 5  | <b>Human</b>  | Completes the Home Profile and lifestyle quiz and turns on <b>Open to Adopt</b> . They get <b>Pets for You</b> and can bookmark pets or send an <b>Invite to Apply</b> .                                                                                                                     |
| 6  | <b>Pet</b>    | Opens <b>Homes for You</b> , picks a home, and sends an <b>adoption request</b> with a cover letter.                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 7  | <b>Human</b>  | Reviews the request and chooses <b>Approve</b> or <b>Decline</b> . On approval, the pet becomes <b>In Process</b> and Meet & Greet booking opens.                                                                                                                                            |
| 8  | <b>Pet</b>    | Books a <b>Meet &amp; Greet</b> from the human's available slots. The human confirms it or proposes another time.                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 9  | <b>Both</b>   | Meet in person. When the scheduled time has passed, the request moves to <b>Awaiting Decision</b> .                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 10 | <b>Human</b>  | Chooses <b>Adopt</b> or <b>Decline</b> . The pet can withdraw at any point before this.                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 11 | <b>System</b> | <b>On Adopt:</b> the pet is marked Adopted automatically, its profile becomes an alumni profile with the <b>Hired</b> badge linked to the human, the human becomes a <b>Furparent</b> , and the pet's other open requests close. <b>On Decline:</b> the pet goes back to Looking for a Home. |
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### The adoption request at a glance



## Status Rules

### 5.1 Account status

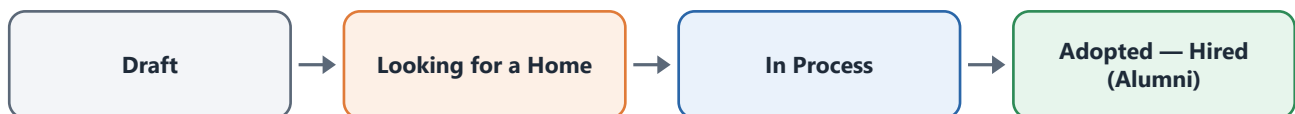


| Status                      | When                                             | What the owner can do                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pending Verification</b> | Right after sign-up                              | Log in only to see the “pending approval” screen and edit the details they submitted. They cannot browse, post, send, or receive anything. |
| <b>Active</b>               | Admin approved                                   | Use every feature available to their role.                                                                                                 |
| <b>Denied</b>               | Admin denied                                     | See the reason, correct their details, and resubmit (back to Pending).                                                                     |
| <b>Suspended</b>            | Admin action, e.g. after confirmed reports       | See the reason only. Profile hidden. An admin can reactivate the account.                                                                  |
| <b>Deactivated</b>          | Owner closes the account, or an admin removes it | Profile hidden. Records are kept for adoption history and logs.                                                                            |

#### What each account submits for verification

- **Human:** full name, birthdate (must be 18 or older), contact number, city and address, and a photo of a valid ID.
- **Pet:** name, species, breed, approximate age, at least one clear photo, where the pet is staying, and the caretaker’s name, contact number, and valid ID. A vet record or shelter certificate is optional but speeds up review.
- Verification documents are visible to admins only.

### 5.2 Pet adoption status



| Status                    | What moves the pet here                                                                                 |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Draft</b>              | Account approved but the résumé’s required fields are not filled in yet. Not shown publicly.            |
| <b>Looking for a Home</b> | Résumé completed, or an in-process request ended without an adoption.                                   |
| <b>In Process</b>         | A human approved one of the pet’s adoption requests.                                                    |
| <b>Adopted — Hired</b>    | The human chose Adopt after the Meet & Greet. This is permanent. The profile becomes an alumni profile. |

**Nobody sets the status by hand.** Only the system changes it, based on what happens with requests. The pet account has no status dropdown. If something goes wrong, for example an adopted pet is returned, an admin can correct the status through **Resolve Adoption Issue**. A reason is required, and the change is recorded in the activity log.

## 5.3 Adoption request status

| Status                        | Meaning                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sent</b>                   | The pet sent the request and is waiting on the human. Expires after 14 days without a response.                          |
| <b>On Hold</b>                | Another of the pet's requests is in process. This one pauses and goes back to Sent if that one ends without an adoption. |
| <b>Approved</b>               | The human approved. The pet can now book a Meet & Greet.                                                                 |
| <b>Meet Scheduled</b>         | A Meet & Greet slot has been confirmed by both sides.                                                                    |
| <b>Awaiting Decision</b>      | The meeting time has passed. The human now chooses Adopt or Decline.                                                     |
| <b>Adopted</b>                | Final. The adoption is complete.                                                                                         |
| <b>Declined / Not Adopted</b> | The human declined, either before the meeting (Declined) or after it (Not Adopted).                                      |
| <b>Withdrawn</b>              | The pet withdrew the request.                                                                                            |
| <b>Closed / Expired</b>       | Closed automatically (the pet was adopted elsewhere, or an account was suspended) or timed out.                          |

## 5.4 Meet & Greet rules

- The human sets available slots (date, time, and a meeting place such as a public spot, the shelter, or the caretaker's location). Booking is only possible after the request is approved.
- The pet books a slot, and the human confirms it. Either side can propose a new time or cancel with a reason. Cancelling reopens booking.
- Phone numbers and exact addresses are shared between the two sides only after the Meet & Greet is confirmed.
- Reminders go out one day and one hour before the meeting.
- After the scheduled time, the human sees **Adopt**, **Decline**, and **It didn't happen** (which reopens booking). Reminders continue for 7 days, and after that the request is flagged for admin follow-up.

## 5.5 Business rules

- A pet can have up to **3 open requests** at once, and only **one** can be in process at a time.
- Only one request can exist for the same pet and human at a time. After a Declined or Not Adopted result, the pet cannot send that home another request for 30 days.
- Adopted pets cannot send requests and do not appear in search or matches.
- Humans receive requests only while **Open to Adopt** is on. Turning it off does not cancel requests already in progress.
- A pet has exactly one Furparent. A human can adopt more than one pet, and the Furparent label stays.
- Only Active accounts can send, receive, book, post, or report.

## SECTION 6

# Matching and Suggestions

The human's lifestyle quiz and the pet's résumé describe the same things from opposite sides. The system compares them in two steps and produces one score from 0 to 100. That score ranks **Pets for You** for humans and **Homes for You** for pets.

### Step 1 — Dealbreakers (excluded from results)

- The species is not one the human accepts.
- The pet is not good with kids and the home has young children.
- The pet is not good with the kind of pet already in the home.

### Step 2 — Weighted score

| Human quiz answer                 | Compared with pet's résumé         | Points |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------|
| Activity level                    | Energy level                       | 20     |
| Hours away from home per day      | How long it can be left alone      | 15     |
| Home type and outdoor space       | Space and yard needs               | 15     |
| Pet experience                    | Experience level it needs          | 15     |
| Preferred size and age            | Size and age                       | 15     |
| Kids and other pets (partial fit) | Compatibility tags (yes / unknown) | 10     |
| Willing to handle special needs   | Special needs or medical care      | 10     |
| Total                             |                                    | 100    |

**Every match explains itself.** A card reads, for example, **92% match** with its top reasons: "Loves long walks — so do you" or "Fine alone for 6 hours — you're out for 5." Results are sorted by score, then by newest. Scores update whenever a quiz or résumé changes.

## SECTION 7

# Functional Requirements

| ID   | Human / Furparent                                                                                                 |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FR1  | Human can register and submit verification details. The account starts as Pending Verification.                   |
| FR2  | Human can log in and use the platform only after admin approval. Pending and denied accounts see a status screen. |
| FR3  | Human can complete and edit a Home Profile and lifestyle quiz.                                                    |
| FR4  | Human can turn <b>Open to Adopt</b> on or off.                                                                    |
| FR5  | Human can view a ranked <b>Pets for You</b> feed with match scores and reasons.                                   |
| FR6  | Human can browse and search pet profiles by species, age, size, temperament, and compatibility.                   |
| FR7  | Human can view a pet's full résumé: photos, bio, skills, temperament, compatibility, and health.                  |
| FR8  | Human can bookmark pet profiles.                                                                                  |
| FR9  | Human can send an <b>Invite to Apply</b> to a pet.                                                                |
| FR10 | Human can review adoption requests sent by pets and approve or decline them, with an optional message.            |
| FR11 | Human can set Meet & Greet availability and confirm, reschedule, or cancel bookings.                              |
| FR12 | Human can choose <b>Adopt</b> or <b>Decline</b> once the Meet & Greet time has passed.                            |
| FR13 | Human automatically receives the <b>Furparent</b> label on adoption, with adopted pets shown on their profile.    |
| FR14 | Furparent can view their adopted pet's alumni profile and adoption details, and post adoption stories.            |
| FR15 | Human receives notifications about requests, Meet & Greets, verification, and announcements.                      |
| FR16 | Human can report a profile, post, comment, or account.                                                            |
| FR17 | Human can post in the community feed, react, and comment.                                                         |
| ID   | Pet Account                                                                                                       |
| FR18 | Pet can register with the caretaker's verification details. The account starts as Pending Verification.           |
| FR19 | Pet can log in and use the platform only after admin approval.                                                    |
| FR20 | Pet can create and edit its résumé: photos, bio, temperament tags, skills, compatibility, and health/vet notes.   |
| FR21 | Pet can view a ranked <b>Homes for You</b> list of humans who are Open to Adopt.                                  |
| FR22 | Pet can browse and search Home Profiles. Only public details are shown, with no exact address or contact number.  |
| FR23 | Pet can bookmark Home Profiles.                                                                                   |
| FR24 | Pet can send an adoption request with a cover letter to a human and track its status.                             |

| ID   | Pet Account                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FR25 | Pet can withdraw a request at any time before the final decision.                                                                                                                  |
| FR26 | Pet can book, reschedule, or cancel a Meet & Greet once a request is approved.                                                                                                     |
| FR27 | Pet's adoption status is changed only by the system. It cannot be edited by hand.                                                                                                  |
| FR28 | On adoption, the pet's profile automatically becomes an alumni profile with a <b>Hired</b> badge linked to its Furparent, and its other open requests close.                       |
| FR29 | Pet can post updates to the community feed, including after adoption.                                                                                                              |
| FR30 | Pet can view its stats: profile views, bookmarks, and request history.                                                                                                             |
| FR31 | Pet receives notifications about invites, requests, Meet & Greets, and verification.                                                                                               |
| FR32 | Pet can report a profile, post, comment, or account.                                                                                                                               |
| ID   | Admin                                                                                                                                                                              |
| FR33 | Admin can review the verification queue for new Human and Pet accounts, and approve or deny each with a reason.                                                                    |
| FR34 | Admin can suspend, reactivate, or deactivate any account.                                                                                                                          |
| FR35 | Admin can review reports and remove, restore, or dismiss the reported content or account.                                                                                          |
| FR36 | Admin can monitor all adoption requests and Meet & Greets, including ones overdue for a decision.                                                                                  |
| FR37 | Admin can resolve adoption issues, such as cancelling an adoption or returning a pet to Looking for a Home. A reason is required and the action is logged.                         |
| FR38 | Admin can manage and monitor alumni profiles.                                                                                                                                      |
| FR39 | Admin can publish platform announcements and notifications.                                                                                                                        |
| FR40 | Admin can view a platform analytics dashboard: accounts by status, verification queue, pets by status, requests, Meet & Greets, adoptions per month, and average days to adoption. |
| FR41 | Admin can view activity logs of important actions (who did what, and when).                                                                                                        |

## SECTION 8

# Non-Functional Requirements

| ID          | Quality        | Requirement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>NFR1</b> | Usability      | Sign-up, résumé, and request flows can be completed without training. Long forms are split into steps with a progress indicator.                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>NFR2</b> | Security       | Passwords are hashed and authentication is session-based. Role-based access is enforced on the server. Pending, denied, and suspended accounts are blocked by the server, not just hidden in the interface.                                                         |
| <b>NFR3</b> | Data integrity | The server enforces the rules in Section 5: adopted pets cannot send or receive requests, each pet has one Furparent, status changes only through the system, Meet & Greet require an approved request, and Adopt/Decline is available only after the meeting time. |
| <b>NFR4</b> | Privacy        | ID documents are visible to admins only. Exact addresses and phone numbers are shared only after a Meet & Greet is confirmed. Home Profiles show only the city and a household summary.                                                                             |
| <b>NFR5</b> | Availability   | Runs reliably on standard web hosting at demo or pilot scale.                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>NFR6</b> | Scalability    | The design leaves room for future changes, such as automatic ID checks or shelter accounts, without a rebuild.                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>NFR7</b> | Performance    | Browse and profile pages load within about 2 seconds on typical broadband or mobile data. Images are compressed.                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>NFR8</b> | Compatibility  | Responsive design that works in both desktop and mobile browsers.                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>NFR9</b> | Accountability | Every admin action and every status change is logged with who made it, when, and why.                                                                                                                                                                               |

## SECTION 9

# Modules

| Module                           | Human / Furparent                  | Pet Account                     | Admin              |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------|
| 1. Authentication & Verification | Sign up, submit ID                 | Sign up, submit caretaker ID    | Approve / deny     |
| 2. Profile Management            | Home Profile & quiz                | Résumé                          | Moderate           |
| 3. Discovery & Search            | Browse pets                        | Browse homes                    | View all           |
| 4. Matching & Suggestions        | Pets for You                       | Homes for You                   | —                  |
| 5. Bookmarks                     | Save pets                          | Save homes                      | —                  |
| 6. Adoption Requests             | Receive, approve / decline, invite | Send, track, withdraw           | Monitor            |
| 7. Meet & Greet                  | Set slots, confirm, decide         | Book, reschedule                | Monitor            |
| 8. Adoption & Alumni             | Adopt, become Furparent            | Becomes alumni (Hired)          | Resolve issues     |
| 9. Notifications                 | Receive                            | Receive                         | Announcements      |
| 10. Community Feed & Stories     | Post, react, comment               | Post updates                    | Moderate           |
| 11. Reports & Moderation         | Report                             | Report                          | Review & act       |
| 12. Account Administration       | Own account                        | Own account                     | All accounts       |
| 13. Analytics                    | Match results, request history     | Views, bookmarks, request stats | Platform dashboard |
| 14. Activity Logs                | Own activity                       | Own activity                    | Full logs          |

## Notifications

| Event                                                     | Notified                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Account approved or denied                                | Account owner               |
| Invite to Apply received                                  | Pet                         |
| Adoption request received / withdrawn                     | Human                       |
| Request approved, declined, expired, or put on hold       | Pet                         |
| Meet & Greet booked, confirmed, rescheduled, or cancelled | The other side              |
| Meet & Greet reminder (1 day and 1 hour before)           | Both                        |
| Decision needed after the meeting                         | Human                       |
| Adoption complete                                         | Both                        |
| Report outcome, suspension, announcements                 | Affected account / everyone |

## SECTION 10

# Future Scope

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Outside the current scope, but the design leaves room for them:

- Direct messaging between a pet and a human after a request is approved.
- Shelter accounts that manage several pet accounts from one dashboard.
- Email and SMS notifications, in addition to in-app notifications.
- Map-based search for nearby pets and homes.
- Automatic ID checks to speed up verification.
- Post-adoption check-ins (for example at 1 week and 1 month) shown on the alumni profile.